TOPIC REPORTS: PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES · LEGISLATION AND REGULATION · DATA PROTECTION · REGIONAL COLLABORATION · STANDARDS · PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

Central African Republic · Chad · Equatorial Guinea · Ethiopia · Gabon · Ghana · Guinea · Kenya · Liberia · Malawi · Mali · Morocco · Niger · Senegal · Somalia · South Africa · South Sudan · Tanzania · Togo · Tunisia · Uganda · Zambia · Zimbabwe

Central African Republic

GOVERNMENT SPOKESPERSON'S COMMUNICATION-MONITORING CELL (CVC-PG)

- **Centrafrique : le gouvernement se dote d'une Cellule de veille communicationnelle pour contrer les rumeurs** — Alwihda Info, 17 September 2026

  The Central African Republic's President Faustin Archange Touadéra signed a decree creating a communication-monitoring cell under the government spokesperson, reported on 17 September 2026. One of its three units handles crisis communication and rumours, monitoring broadcast, print, online and social media at home and abroad. It is funded from the state budget; the decree's date is not given.

Chad

FABRICATED JOURNALIST IDENTITIES PLACED IN AFRICAN MEDIA

- **Désinformation en Afrique : un rapport alerte sur un réseau de « journalistes fantômes » lié à des opérations d'influence russes** — Le N'Djam Post, 4 September 2026

  A Code for Africa and Graphika report published in August 2026 identifies 44 fabricated identities, 35 of them "ghost journalists" and nine fake experts, used between 2021 and 2026 to place content favourable to Russian interests in African media. The content appeared on 138 websites and was relayed by at least 113 Facebook accounts and pages.

INTERNET SHUTDOWN IN LAC PROVINCE

- **Lac : Un citoyen appelle à un réexamen de la connectivité internet** — Toumaï Web Médias, 10 September 2026

  In an open letter to Chad's president, reported on 10 September 2026, Aboubakar Mahamat Tidjani says internet access in Lac province has been heavily restricted for nearly two years on security grounds, harming pupils, teachers and traders. He asks for phased, secured restoration where conditions allow, retention of essential services and better public information on the measure.

Equatorial Guinea

PROSECUTION AND ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION COORDINATION PROTOCOL

- **Fiscalía y Comisión Anticorrupción pactan coordinación permanente para luchar contra la corrupción en Guinea Ecuatorial** — Revista Real Equatorial Guinea, 4 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Attorney General Anatolio Nzang Nguema Mangue and the new head of the anti-corruption commission, Santiago Casto Nvono Bibang, agreed on 3 September 2026 to set up permanent coordination against corruption. The plan includes liaison points, a protocol for exchanging information, periodic review meetings and joint training for officials.

Ethiopia

COMMUNICATIONS DISRUPTION IN TIGRAY

- **Tigray Cut Off Again as Communications Blackout Deepens Civilian Misery** — WardheerNews, 26 September 2026

  Internet and phone services were severely disrupted across Ethiopia's Tigray region as fighting resumed between Tigrayan forces and the federal army, reported on 26 September 2026. Ethio Telecom services were fully down and Safaricom partly working, and NetBlocks confirmed the disruption. Residents already short of cash lost access to mobile money. Responsibility for the shutdown is disputed.

Gabon

HAUTE AUTORITE DE LA COMMUNICATION DECISION N 0002/HAC/2026 SUSPENDING SOCIAL MEDIA

- **Réseaux sociaux : après 9 mois, l'aveu du porte-parole de la Présidence relance la polémique** — Gabon Mail Infos, 6 October 2026

  Gabon's presidential spokesman said on radio that he uses a VPN, outside the law, to get round the social-media suspension the communications authority imposed in February 2026. The outlet reports the suspension still in force and the authority silent on any sanction.

Ghana

CIVIC EDUCATION POSITION ON MISINFORMATION AND SYNTHETIC MEDIA

- **Misinformation, deepfakes pose serious threat to Ghana's democratic stability – NCCE** — MyJoyOnline, 1 September 2026

  Ghana's National Commission for Civic Education said misinformation, hate speech and deepfakes threaten democratic stability, its chair Kathleen Addy telling a media event in Accra that fabricated images and audio mean seeing and hearing no longer count as proof. The EU's deputy ambassador announced support for a new African Media Integrity and Resilience Programme on verification skills.

PROSECUTION OF ONLINE SPEECH UNDER THE FALSE-NEWS PROVISIONS OF THE CRIMINAL OFFENCES ACT, 1960

- **Barker-Vormawor urges courts to scrutinise rights violations in Ghana Jollof case** — MyJoyOnline, 19 September 2026

  Ghana is prosecuting a senior nursing officer, Salomey Awiti Bafoh, under the false-news provisions of the Criminal Offences Act over videos from the UK-based "Ghana Jollof" TikTok account. Arrested on 13 September 2026, she was denied bail and remanded to 30 September. Lawyer Oliver Barker-Vormawor said on 19 September that the use of mobile-money records and device access needs close judicial oversight.

- **Ghana Jollof Case - Does section 208 of criminal code only apply to NPP? Ntim Fordjour questions** — MyJoyOnline, 19 September 2026

Ghanaian opposition MP John Ntim Fordjour asked on JoyNews on 19 September 2026 whether section 208 of the Criminal Offences Act, on false publications, is applied only to NPP supporters and government critics. He criticised the police CID over the arrest of a nursing officer linked to the TikTok user known as Ghana Jollof, and said pro-government content goes unpunished.

ROADMAP ON HATE SPEECH AND HARMFUL ONLINE CONTENT

- **National Stakeholder Engagement on Hate Speech, Abusive Online Content and Responsible Digital Communication (OPS308.3.26.1386)** — Office of the President, Republic of Ghana, 22 September 2026

  Ghana's presidency asked the Media Foundation for West Africa and the Ghana Journalists Association, in a letter dated 22 September 2026, to convene a national stakeholder engagement on hate speech and harmful online content. It asks for guidelines for law enforcement, alternatives to arrest for non-criminal speech, and a roadmap with a timetable for the President.

Guinea

BAN ON FRANCE 24 ACROSS BROADCAST AND ONLINE PLATFORMS

- **« Offense au Président »: La chaîne France 24 interdite de diffusion en Guinée, l'ARPT réquisitionnée** — africaguinee.com, 17 September 2026

  Guinea's media regulator (HAC) revoked France 24's broadcasting authorisation with immediate effect on 17 September 2026, citing offence to the President, and withdrew its journalists' accreditation. The telecoms regulator ARPT was ordered to block the channel's websites, streams and apps, and Canal+ Guinée to cut its signal.

COMMUNICATION AUTHORITY BAN ON UNAUTHORISED WEB TV CHANNELS AND NEWS SITES

- **Médias numériques : la HAC interdit dix « prétendues » Web TV et deux sites d'information pour exercice illégal** — Mediaguinee, 21 September 2026

  Guinea's media regulator, the Haute Autorité de la Communication, on 21 September 2026 banned ten web TV channels and two news sites nationwide and on all digital platforms for broadcasting online without authorisation. Those named include Dabola TV, Coyah TV and Siguiri 24 Star TV. The regulator said earlier warnings to regularise had been ignored.

- **Guinée : la HAC interdit Baro TV et sanctionne son promoteur Lamine Camara** — Mediaguinee, 26 September 2026

  Guinea's media regulator, the Haute Autorité de la Communication, banned Baro TV, a web television service in Kouroussa prefecture, at an extraordinary session on 24 September 2026. It ruled that the service was broadcasting audiovisual information online illegally and that its promoter, Lamine Camara, does not hold professional journalist status.

- **Médias en ligne : la HAC interdit quatre Web TV en Guinée** — Mediaguinee, 26 September 2026

  Guinea's media regulator, the Haute Autorité de la Communication, banned four web TV outlets — Fewndaare TV, Global TV, Kimanbourou TV and BTV — with immediate effect at an extraordinary session on 26 September 2026. It said they broadcast audiovisual content online without any legal authorisation, and that web TV on digital platforms requires one.

Kenya

CIVIL-SOCIETY POSITION ON DIGITAL TAXATION

- **Why Kenyan Creators Are Pushing Back on the YouTube Tax** — KICTANet, 2 September 2026

  Kenyan creators are contesting the withholding tax on video-platform earnings, which sits alongside the digital services tax, value-added tax on digital marketplace supply and the digital asset tax. The civil-society network carrying the campaign published its own brief on digital-tax reform in 2024.

LITIGATION OVER THE DIGITAL SUPERHIGHWAY TENDERS

- **Why High Court quashed Attorney General's opinion on Digital Superhighway tender** — Pulse Kenya, 4 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court on 4 September 2026 quashed a Solicitor-General's advisory of 1 October 2024 that cleared the Digital Superhighway tender awarded to Nightigale (EA) Limited of conflict-of-interest concerns. Justice Lawrence Mugambi ruled the question belonged to the Ethics and Anti-Corruption Commission and referred it there. The fibre project was put at more than Sh15 billion, funded from the Universal Service Fund.

- **High Court nullifies Attorney General's opinion on which Communications Authority relied upon to pay its former Chairperson Mary Wambui Mungai** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 4 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court quashed as unconstitutional the Attorney-General's advisory opinion of 1 October 2024 clearing a former Communications Authority chairperson of conflict of interest over two Digital Superhighway tenders awarded to Nightigale, according to the Consumers Federation of Kenya, which brought the case. The court did not void the contracts, and said the anti-corruption commission is the forum to investigate.

HERSPACE KENYA

- **HerSpace Kenya: A New Initiative to Confront Technology-Facilitated Gender-Based Violence** — KICTANet, 25 September 2026

  The Kenya ICT Action Network launched HerSpace Kenya, a two-year programme backed by Co-Impact against technology-facilitated gender-based violence. It will train police, prosecutors and judges to handle digital evidence, train women on reporting, and engage platforms on content moderation. A 2023 KICTANet study found 54% of women respondents had experienced such violence.

Liberia

DISCLOSURE OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS SECTOR REVENUE

- **Liberia: LTA Embarrasses Boakai** — allAfrica.com (The New Republic Liberia), 3 September 2026

  The New Republic reported on 3 September 2026 that Liberia's President Joseph Boakai summoned the Telecommunications Authority's acting chairperson, Clarence Massaquoi, to the Executive Mansion over undisclosed revenue activities. Civil society and the media have sought disclosure of sector revenue for months. Commissioners can be removed only for established cause; the report rests on unnamed sources.

DIGITAL ADVOCACY AND RIGHTS ALLIANCE (DARA)

- **Ten CSOs Form Digital Rights Coalition** — Liberian Observer, 24 September 2026

  Ten Liberian civil society organisations signed a memorandum founding the Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance. It commits them to press for an independent data protection authority, amendments narrowing the Cybercrime Act of 2025 and tighter oversight of state interception, and court authorisation for internet shutdowns. A founding assembly is due within 90 days; the signing date is not given.

- **Liberia: Ten Liberian Civil Society Groups Launch Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance** — FrontPage Africa, 25 September 2026

Ten Liberian civil society organisations, including CENTAL and the Liberia Equality Network, signed a memorandum establishing the Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance (DARA). The coalition is to work on digital rights, privacy, online safety and digital freedoms.

Malawi

OPEN GOVERNMENT PARTNERSHIP NATIONAL ACTION PLAN 2025-2028

- **Malawi Action Plan Review 2026-2029 - Open Government Partnership** — Open Government Partnership, 14 October 2026

  The Open Government Partnership's Independent Reporting Mechanism reviewed Malawi's 2026–2029 action plan, which has 11 commitments covering anti-corruption, natural resources, fiscal openness, digital governance and climate. They include a public beneficial ownership register and public party-finance information. The review finds Malawi did not meet the minimum co-creation standards.

Mali

SPEECH PROSECUTIONS BEFORE THE CYBERCRIME POLE

- **Cybercriminalité : le journaliste Abdrahamane Keïta condamné à deux ans de prison ferme** — Maliweb, 14 September 2026

  Mali's cybercrime tribunal sentenced journalist Abdrahamane KeÃ¯ta, publication director of Le TÃ©moin, to two years in prison and 1 million CFA francs in damages over a television remark about Kidal. He has been detained since June, and his defence intends to appeal.

Morocco

TACIT-APPROVAL PROPOSAL FOR ADMINISTRATIVE DECISIONS

- **La petite révolution administrative cachée dans le programme de l'Istiqlal** — L'ODJ, 4 September 2026

  Morocco's Istiqlal party proposes in its election programme that, for some procedures, an administration's silence after a set deadline should count as approval, columnist Mamoune Acharki wrote in L'ODJ on 4 September 2026. The programme also proposes fewer prior authorisations, more use of specifications, and faster digitisation of procedures. No list of procedures or deadlines is given.

PUBLIC ARGUMENT OVER THE SPYWARE ALLEGATIONS

- **حداد يفند مزاعم اختراق المغرب لهاتف سانشيز** — Assabah, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan academic and politician rejected as overstated the July 2026 consortium findings tying Moroccan bodies to the compromise of the Spanish prime minister’s phone.

- **من 'تصفية المنظري' إلى 'بيغاسوس'.. هل يفتح القضاء الإسباني ملف حيجاوي؟** — Hespress, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan analysis asks why Spanish prosecutors have taken no action against a former intelligence officer since 2010, and whether the spyware row now reopens that file.

Niger

MEDIA AND PLATFORM MONITORING AFTER THE EVENTS OF 28-29 AUGUST 2026

- **Medias : Ameliorer l''ecosysteme de l''information et de la communication en temps de crise au centre d''une rencontre a Niamey** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 2 September 2026

Niger's communications minister Adji Ali Salatou and the national communication observatory (ONC) met media chiefs in Niamey on 2 September 2026 after the events of 28-29 August at the capital's air base. The ONC presented its monitoring of broadcast, online and platform content from 28 August to 1 September, citing an information vacuum, conflicting descriptions of the events and disinformation on social networks.

- **Rencontre entre le ministre charge de la Communication, le president de l''ONC et les promoteurs de medias : l''ONC devoile les conclusions d''un monitoring** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 3 September 2026

  Niger's national communication observatory (ONC) presented its monitoring of coverage of the 28-29 August 2026 events in Niamey to media owners on 2 September, alongside the communications minister. It found intense information demand, an information vacuum, official and international media describing the events differently, and old images and out-of-context video circulating on social networks.

Senegal

PARLIAMENTARY QUESTIONS ON THE SITING OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS MASTS

- **Pylones de telecommunications a proximite des habitations : Thierno Alassane Sall alerte sur les risques** — Seneweb, 6 September 2026

  Senegalese MP Thierno Alassane Sall sent written questions to several ministers about telecoms masts being built close to homes, citing a mast under construction in Ngaparou, Mbour department. Residents say they complained to the regulator ARTP, the commune and the sub-prefect without reply. He asks whether safety and health impact studies were carried out and permits issued.

Somalia

STATE TAKEDOWN OF SOCIAL MEDIA PAGES

- **Somali government closes 82,000 extremist-linked social media pages in 2026** — Hiiraan Online, 4 September 2026

  Somalia's federal government has shut 82,000 social media pages in 2026 that it says armed groups used for extremist propaganda, Ministry of Information director general Abdullahi Hayir Duale said in Mogadishu on 3 September 2026. He named Facebook, TikTok and Telegram among the platforms and said closures will continue. No figures on appeals or oversight are given.

South Africa

HARMFUL ONLINE CONTENT GOVERNANCE REVIEW

- **When harm goes viral: Multistakeholder forum launches timely report on South Africa's social media problem** — Research ICT Africa, 18 September 2026

  Research ICT Africa, the Centre for Analytics and Behavioural Change and Moxii Africa launched a study in Johannesburg on 17 September 2026 finding that South Africa's laws on harmful online content are adequate but enforcement is fragmented. It found platform moderation in English alone leaves out 10 of 11 official languages, and that cases of harassment, doxxing and deepfakes can take up to seven years to resolve. The study was EU-funded.

South Sudan

ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY FOR ACCESS TO INFORMATION

- **Rights officials accuse government of treating civil society as 'enemies' - Radio Tamazuj** — Radio Tamazuj, 2 September 2026

  South Sudan Human Rights Commission officials told a Juba panel on 2 September 2026 that the government treats civil society organisations as enemies or political opponents. Deputy chair Ezekia A. Gibson rated transparency and participation weak and accountability very weak; participants said the National Revenue Authority does not consistently publish the revenue data it is required to release.

Tanzania

LITIGATION OVER PLATFORM ACCOUNT SUSPENSIONS

- **Tanzanian influencer sues Meta over alleged government-driven account suspensions** — TechCabal, 1 September 2026

  The Tanzanian activist and influencer Mange Kimambi filed a 36-page complaint against Meta in a California court on 21 August, alleging her accounts were disabled under pressure from Tanzanian authorities during a period of political unrest. The allegation is untested.

Togo

CIVIC SPACE RATING

- **Togo - Civicus Monitor** — CIVICUS Monitor, 4 September 2026

  The CIVICUS Monitor rates Togo's civic space as Repressed, with a current score of 29 out of 100. Togo has been rated Repressed every year from 2020 to 2024, after Obstructed in 2018 and 2019. The page carries no publication date.

TOGO INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **Forum National sur la Gouvernance de l'Internet au Togo 2026** — Internet Society Togo / Forum National sur la Gouvernance de l'Internet au Togo (Togo IGF), 4 September 2026

  Togo's 12th national Internet Governance Forum was held in Lomé on 19 June 2026 on artificial intelligence, big data and digital sovereignty. The forum, run annually since 2010 under the Tunis Agenda, brings together government, civil society, the private sector, academia and the technical community; its programme listed the digital ministry, the regulator ARCEP and the cybersecurity and data-protection agencies.

Tunisia

DECREE-LAW 54 ON CYBER-OFFENCES AND ITS REVISION

- **مقترح قانون عدد 017 / 2024 يتعلق بتنقيح واتمام المرسوم عدد 54 لسنة 2022 المتعلق بمكافحة الجرائم المتصلة بأنظمة المعلومات والاتصال** — Assemblée des Représentants du Peuple (ARP), 6 September 2026

  Parliament's own case file for the bill amending Tunisia's 2022 cyber-offences decree-law puts dates on a revision that has been called a priority: deposited on 20 February 2024, referred to committee on 10 April 2025, carrying 38 sponsors, and still unvoted. The amendments themselves are not published on the page, so what the bill would change remains unstated.

- **مجلس الوزراء ينظر في تنقيح 3 مراسيم.. من بينها المرسوم 54** — Al Chourouk, 30 September 2026

  Tunisia's Council of Ministers, chaired by President Kais Saied, discussed a draft decree amending Decree 54 of 2022 on crimes involving information and communication systems on 29 September 2026. The content of the amendment was not published.

Uganda

URA E-TAX2 AWARD

- **URA engages manufacturers on new tax reforms, digital systems and import fee changes** — Mulengera News, 11 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority told manufacturers on 11 September 2026 that its eTax2 platform, in development since February 2026, will be web-only and will replace Tax Identification Numbers with National Identification Numbers and Business Registration Numbers. URA said the change is meant to fix duplicate and fragmented records in the taxpayer register.

Zambia

PROSECUTION OF ONLINE SPEECH UNDER THE CYBER SECURITY AND CYBER CRIMES ACT 2021

- **Court convicts vlogger Chishimba over Mwanawasa allegations** — Mwebantu, 11 September 2026

  A Lusaka magistrate convicted vlogger Joseph Chishimba on 11 September 2026 under section 54 of Zambia's Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021 for forwarding to a WhatsApp group, in October 2024, a screenshot making allegations about presidential aide Chipokota Mwanawasa. The court found forensic evidence showed it was sent from his phone, though the post itself was not recovered. Sentencing was adjourned.

- **Mansa tailor nabbed for insulting HH on TikTok** — News Diggers, 12 September 2026

  Police in Mansa arrested a 38-year-old man over a TikTok video allegedly insulting President Hakainde Hichilema, charging him under Zambia's Cyber Crimes Act with harassment using electronic gadgets. The police statement is dated 11 September 2026, after the Secretary to the Cabinet warned that insulting the President would be prosecuted.

- **Vlogger gets 9 months for sharing screenshot about Mwanawasa's false pregnancy** — News Diggers, 15 September 2026

  A Lusaka magistrate sentenced vlogger Joseph Chishimba to nine months on 15 September 2026, four days after convicting him under section 54 of Zambia's Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021. He had posted to a WhatsApp group in October 2024 a screenshot of a Facebook post making claims about Chipo Mwanawasa.

- **Police nab TikToker for saying truck drivers steal fuel, have poor hygiene** — News Diggers, 19 September 2026

  Police in Ndola, Zambia, arrested a 24-year-old TikToker, Natasha Nambeya, for allegedly harassing truck drivers, after a trustee of the Truck Drivers Association of Zambia complained about videos accusing drivers of stealing fuel and poor hygiene.

Zimbabwe

PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEE OF THE FUTURE

- **DR. B. Chirume Appointed To Parliamentary Committee Of The Future As Zimbabwe Eyes 30-Year Digital Roadmap** — TechnoMag, 4 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT ministry said its permanent secretary, Beaullah Chirume, has been appointed to Parliament's Committee of the Future, which plans a 30-year outlook tied to Vision 2056. TechnoMag reports the committee is expected to plan for AI, cybersecurity and rural connectivity, and notes ZIMPOST's 300-plus offices are being repurposed for digital inclusion.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-20**
COMPILED	By Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository
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